GOVERNMENT OF INDIA

Ministry of Skill Development & Entrepreneurship

Building Skills Creating Opportunities

Confidential and Proprietory
August 2026

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BUILDING SKILLS CREATING OPPORTUNITIES

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June 2026

SHRI NARENDRA MODI

HONORABLE PRIME MINISTER, INDIA



MESSAGE

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SHRI JAYANT CHAUDHARY

HONORABLE MINISTER,
MINISTRY OF SKILL DEVELOPMENT
AND ENTREPRENEURSHIP



MESSAGE

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SHRI MUNINDRA KUMAR

DIRECTOR GENERAL, CHAMBER OF COMMERCE AND INDUSTRIES OF INDIA



MESSAGE

India's greatest strength lies in its youthful population, whose skills, talent, and entrepreneurial spirit will determine the nation's future growth and global competitiveness. The Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship plays a transformative role in equipping the workforce with industry-relevant skills, promoting entrepreneurship, enhancing employability, and creating opportunities that contribute to inclusive and sustainable economic development.

The Chamber of Commerce and Industries of India (CCI India) firmly believes that a skilled workforce is the foundation of a resilient and innovation-driven economy. Through policy advocacy, industry-academia collaboration, skill development programmes, entrepreneurship promotion, startup support, investment facilitation, capacity building, and employment linkages, CCI India remains committed to supporting the Ministry's vision of developing globally competitive human capital.

This Knowledge Paper provides comprehensive insights into the Ministry's strategic priorities, policy framework, institutional initiatives, skill ecosystem, entrepreneurship programmes, investment opportunities, and emerging trends shaping the future of work. It explores collaborative opportunities across digital skills, advanced manufacturing, green jobs, startup incubation, vocational education, industry certification, women entrepreneurship, and lifelong learning.

As India prepares to lead the global knowledge economy, investment in skills and entrepreneurship will remain one of the country's greatest priorities. CCI India looks forward to partnering with the Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship in empowering individuals, strengthening industries, and building a future-ready workforce.

Munindra Kumar
Director General
CCI India

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Preface

India stands at an inflection point in its economic trajectory. With over 65 per cent of its population below the age of 35, the country possesses one of the world's most significant demographic dividends a structural advantage that, if harnessed effectively, can propel India into the league of developed economies well ahead of the Viksit Bharat 2047 target. The Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship (MSDE) is the sovereign institutional mechanism through which this demographic potential is converted into productive economic capital.

Established in 2014 as a dedicated central ministry, MSDE coordinates India's skilling ecosystem across vocational education, technical training, entrepreneurship facilitation, and workforce quality assurance. Its mandate spans the full labour market lifecycle from school-to-work transition for first-time job seekers, to upskilling and reskilling of existing workers navigating technological disruption, to enabling aspiring entrepreneurs with credit, mentorship, and market access. The Ministry operates through an architecture of flagship schemes, autonomous bodies, sector skill councils, and public-private partnerships that together constitute the world's largest structured skilling programme.

This Knowledge Paper has been prepared by CCI India the Chamber of Commerce and Industry of India as a strategic advisory document aimed at mapping the Ministry's mandate, institutional structure, programmatic landscape, performance trajectory, and future opportunity horizon. The paper has been designed to serve as a working reference for senior policymakers, bureaucrats, industry captains, development finance institutions, and international partners who seek a rigorous and analytically grounded understanding of India's skill development ecosystem.

The primary objective of this document is to articulate and substantiate CCI India's positioning as a multi-dimensional strategic partner for MSDE spanning policy facilitation, industry mobilisation, investment promotion, skilling delivery, startup enablement, and ecosystem co-creation. CCI India is uniquely constituted to bridge the persistent divide between government intent and industry execution a divide that continues to constrain the effective absorption of India's trained workforce into quality employment.

This paper draws upon government data, Ministry annual reports, Budget documents, NSDC publications, ILO benchmarks, World Bank skill-economy indices, and CCI India's own institutional intelligence to construct a balanced, evidence-based, and forward-oriented strategic narrative. The paper has been structured to be immediately actionable with specific frameworks, programme designs, funding architectures, and a five-year roadmap that can be operationalised through a formal Memorandum of Understanding between MSDE and CCI India.

India's skill imperative is not merely a policy priority it is a civilisational challenge. The decisions made in this decade regarding how India trains, places, and empowers its young workforce will define the country's social contract, economic competitiveness, and global standing for the next fifty years. CCI India approaches this partnership with the conviction that industry, when genuinely integrated into the sovereign skilling mission, can dramatically accelerate outcomes that government alone cannot achieve at scale.

Chamber of Commerce and Industry (CCI India)

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About CCI India

CCI India (The Chamber of Commerce and Industry of India) is a premier national business chamber dedicated to fostering economic growth, industry development, entrepreneurship, innovation, and investment promotion across India. As the voice of Indian business and industry, CCI India serves as a bridge between government, industry, startups, academia, investors, and civil society, facilitating meaningful collaboration for nation-building and sustainable development.

Through policy advocacy, business facilitation, research, stakeholder engagement, capacity building, and strategic partnerships, CCI India works to create an enabling environment for enterprises of all sizes. The Chamber actively supports key national initiatives such as Startup India, Make in India, Digital India, Atmanirbhar Bharat, Skill India, and Viksit Bharat 2047 by connecting innovative enterprises with government opportunities and promoting inclusive economic development.

CCI India operates through sector-specific councils, industry forums, knowledge platforms, and state-level engagements that address emerging opportunities and challenges across sectors including manufacturing, agriculture, technology, healthcare, education, infrastructure, sustainability, MSMEs, and startups. The Chamber regularly organizes policy dialogues, investment summits, business delegations, workshops, conferences, and knowledge-sharing initiatives to strengthen India's economic ecosystem.

With a strong commitment to innovation, entrepreneurship, and public-private collaboration, CCI India strives to empower enterprises, facilitate investment, enhance competitiveness, and contribute to India's journey toward becoming a globally competitive and economically resilient nation. Its role as a knowledge partner and industry catalyst enables ministries, departments, state governments, startups, and businesses to collaborate effectively in achieving national development objectives.

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